

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter in association with 

Welcome to the 5th issue of the Bernera News. With life slowly returning to a more normal rhythm, and more people starting to get out and about, we've taken the decision to reduce the frequency of our newsletters. Going forward we shall now produce a **Bernera News** once a month, to be published at the start of each month.

We'd still very much like your contributions, so if you have a story to tell, or information to share, please don't hesitate to get in touch.

We'd also like to set a bit of a challenge. We're running a small **photographic competition**, open to all residents of Bernera and Tir Mor. A £10 Amazon voucher is up for grabs for the best photo, as judged by a small panel. The theme for this competition is "summer", and our only rules are that the picture should have been taken in Bernera or Tir Mor, and that the photo is not digitally altered in any way.

So, if you'd like to enter, and be in with a chance of winning the voucher, please send any photos to us either by whatsapp or by email. Details below. Please make sure you include your name and contact details (and age if you're under 18), and that you are happy for us to use the picture in a future edition. Closing date for entries is 31st July.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

DOCTORS SURGERY

From Monday 6th July, Langabhat Medical Practice will partially reopen at all sites. They will open on select days, offering a small number of clinics for patients who need to be seen face to face. The sites will be open at a reduced level, compared to previous opening times, in order to ensure patient and staff safety. Prescription deliveries will continue and you are asked that you only attend the surgery for appointments, or if asked to come in for any other reason.

Bernera Surgery current opening hours will be:

Monday: **2:30 - 5pm** Tuesday: **Closed** Wednesday: **12-5pm**
Thursday: **Closed** Friday: **Closed**

SHOP NEWS

From Friday 10th July it is now mandatory to wear a face covering whilst in any shop within Scotland. Please ensure that you follow this, as well as adhering to all other instructions, such as using the hand sanitiser on entry, as well as maintaining at least 2 metre social distancing at all times. There is still a limit of 1 customer at a time allowed in the shop.

FOOD BANK COLLECTION POINT

In support of the Eilean Siar Foodbank Project, The Scottish Fire and Rescue Service have established a drop-off facility at community fire stations throughout Lewis, including in Bernera. If you are able to donate any goods, dried or tinned, please drop off in the box provided outside the fire station.

COVID UPDATE

As lockdown restrictions are slowly eased a few changes have come into effect this week. You are now permitted to meet up to 4 other households **outside** at a time, up to 15 people in total. You may also meet up to 2 other households **inside** at a time, up to 8 people in total. This includes overnight stays. However, it is to be remembered that physical distancing rules and enhanced hygiene measures should still be followed at this time.

COMMUNITY SKIP

The community skip, located outside of the Community Centre, is open each Saturday from 10am to 12 noon. If you are using it please remember to maintain social distancing, and only 1 person is allowed at the skip at a time. The Comhairle states that this service is for the disposal of bulky household wastes only, with some restrictions. The disposal of Commercial and Industrial wastes into the Community Skip is strictly prohibited.

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Examples of what the skip can be used for include:

Living room Furniture; Garden Furniture; Carpets & Rugs; Small Sheds (dismantled); Linoleum; Trampolines; Laminate Flooring; Clothes Poles; Bedroom Furniture; Small Garden Gates; Mattresses; Small Quantities of Garden Fencing; Kitchen Furniture; Garden Equipment; Bathroom Furniture; Packaging boxes; Stair Gates; Christmas Trees; Ironing Boards; Manageable Wood Pieces; Luggage; Prams and Buggies; Wheelchairs; Toys & Bicycles.

Examples of prohibited waste:

Construction Wastes; Demolition Wastes; Crofting or Farm Wastes; Stoves; Asbestos; Chemicals; Fireplaces; Soil; Silage Wrap; Back Boilers; Stone or Rubble; Car Parts; Baths; Plasterboard; Oil or Batteries; Paints; Windows or doors; Oil Tanks; Gas Cylinders; Garage doors; Tyres or Wheels; Fish or Animal By-products of any kind; Waste Electrical and Electronic Equipment: (e.g. Fridges, Freezers, Microwaves, TVs, Cookers, Computers, Printers, Irons, Kettles, Toasters, Stereos etc.); grass cuttings.

BUS SERVICE

BERNERA TO STORNOWAY

Days Operated - Monday to Saturday

Bosta Depart		x
Croir	7:15	x
Tobson	7:20	8:54
Valasay	x	x
Hacklete	07:30x	9:05
Breaclete	07:34x	9:10
Kirkibost T Junction	x	9:15
Kirkibost Pier & Side Rd	x	x
Kirkibost to South	x	x
Dun Innes	x	x
Barraglom R.E	07:49x	9:20
Earshader	07:50x	9:21
Crulivig	07:52x	9:23
Lundale	07:54x	9:25
Bernera Junction	08:00x	9:31
Linshader Village		9:34
Garynahine	08:07c	09:40p
Stornoway Bus Stn	8:37	10:05

STORNOWAY TO BERNERA

Days Operated - Monday to Saturday

Stornoway Bus Stn	12:00	18:00
Garynahine	12:25	18:30c
Linshader Village		
Bernera Junction	12:30c	18:35
Lundale	12:36	18:41
Crulivig	12:38	18:43
Earshader	12:40	18:45
Barraglom R.E	12:41	18:46
Dun Innes	12:43	18:48
Kirkibost T Junction	12:46	18:52
Kirkibost Pier & Side Rd	12:47	18:55
Kirkibost to South	12:48	18:58
Breaclete	12:49	19:03
Valasay	12:50	19:08
Hacklete Arrive	12:52	19:10
Tobson	13:03	19:15
Croir	13:08	19:20
Bosta Arrive	13:13	19:25

A new bus timetable has been released for those in Bernera and Tir Mor. All services must be pre-booked by 5pm the previous day on **01851 643218**, or by email **mmmaciver@aol.com**. Email bookings must receive confirmation the previous working day before travelling. Due to current social distancing measures places are limited, with customers being offered the next available day if the bus is full. **You are kindly reminded that it is mandatory to wear a face covering on all public transport, in line with government regulations.**

SEPSIS

Every 3 seconds, someone in the world dies of sepsis. This is the startling fact from the UK Sepsis Trust. Sepsis (also known as blood poisoning) is the immune system's overreaction to an infection or an injury. If not treated immediately, sepsis can result in organ failure and death. Yet with early diagnosis, it can be treated with antibiotics.

As many of you may know, our dear team member, Julia, was taken seriously ill with sepsis a few weeks' ago. We are forever grateful for the recognition of the symptoms leading to prompt treatment, and so want to ensure that others are also aware.

We therefore hope you don't mind us using the Bernera News to share this information, that could be life-saving.

How to spot sepsis in adults

Seek urgent medical help if you (or another adult) develop any of these signs:

- S**lurred speech or confusion
- E**xtrême shivering or muscle pain
- P**assing no urine (in a day)
- S**evere breathlessness
- I**t feels like you're going to die
- S**kin mottled or discoloured.

How to spot sepsis in children

If your child is unwell with either a

fever or very low temperature (or has had a fever in the last 24 hours), call 999 and just ask: could this be sepsis?

A child may have sepsis if he or she:

1. Is breathing very fast
2. Has a 'fit' or convulsion
3. Looks mottled, bluish, or pale
4. Has a rash that does not fade when you press it
5. Is very lethargic or difficult to wake
6. Feels abnormally cold to touch

A child under 5 may have sepsis if he or she:

1. Is not feeding
2. Is vomiting repeatedly
3. Has not passed urine for 12 hours

BERNERA HISTORICAL SOCIETY AND MUSEUM

Bernera Museum and Iron Age House will not be opening during 2020.

It is with regret and sadness that the trustees have decided that we cannot open either the museum or Iron Age House this year. The Scottish government comprehensive guidelines for museums to open from the 15th of July have been carefully reviewed and it has been decided that due to the size and nature of both

buildings that there is too great a risk on social distancing, ventilation, hygiene and cleaning to our visitors, volunteers and community.

In the meantime we will continue to post photos and stories from our archive on Facebook, our website and here in Bernera News as well as continue to work on the projects that we have recently started and shared with you.



Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



ALL SORTS CLUB

As members of Age Scotland the All Sorts Club are sent guides and advice from time to time that is of interest and help to members and the community. The latest we want to share here with everyone.

To mark Age Scotland's 'Scams Awareness Fortnight', they asked Bank of Scotland and the Royal Bank of Scotland to share some top tips on protecting ourselves and our families. They're warning people about "impersonation scams" which often involve someone pretending to be from their bank or the police, who may ask them to quickly transfer money to a "safe account".

They advise being wary of:

Unexpected calls - If you didn't expect the call then it could be a scam

Pressure calls - Fraudsters want to hurry you into making a quick decision and might ask you to "keep it quiet"

Refunds - Banks will never call about a refund - this is a scam

Calls from the police - Police will very rarely call, and they will always follow up with a visit from an officer with photo ID and a warrant number

If you do get a cold call:

Hang up and call back - If you're not sure, tell them you'll call back. Use a number you trust, or dial 101 for the police

Take five - Ideally call back from another phone. If you can't, then wait five minutes to ensure a scammer isn't still on the line

Contact your bank - Don't trust the number on your caller display. If you have doubts, call the number on the back of your bank card

Do not transfer any money - Your bank or the police will never ask you to move money from your account

Whether you're a silver surfer or a digital native, then staying safe online is vital. A few simple steps are:

Make passwords unique - Don't recycle the same ones or use ones that are easy to guess

Never share personal information - This includes PINs, passwords, or one time passcodes

Do not log onto your computer - Unless you called for help with online banking, don't log on to your computer for an unexpected call or allow someone remote access

Do not say what is on your computer screen - A genuine caller will never ask you for this

Age Scotland's full 'Avoiding Scams Guide' can be found at the Age Scotland Website.

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS...

While clearing his land in Western Samoa, Robert Louis Stevenson was alleged to utter that gardening was more satisfying than writing. Indeed, he wrote to Victorian novelist RD Blackmore: "I would rather do a good hour's work weeding... than write two pages of my best... Nothing is so interesting."*

Stevenson was possibly just looking for an excuse to avoid writing, as few things are so difficult to do well. But on the other hand, many like RLS have found working the soil an obsession. Weeds are only a foe to be conquered. At Vailima, the primary pernicious villain was Tuitui or candlenut. Here on the Western Isles, it is perhaps the acid soil-loving common rush (*Juncus effusus*). And climate differences aside, one can imagine that the gardening on Bernera and Tir Mor to be as challenging as the jungles of Upolu.

As my time in Eilean Siar approaches an anticipated end, I can look to the garden in Earshader as a decade-old work in progress. Planting around the house began in 2011 and only today is it feeling established, with rowans and honeysuckle flowering for the first time. Ravaged by gales, it has been a slog to see shrubs and trees begin to show signs of maturity. A birch that might grow a meter or more a year in a Glasgow garden can barely achieve a fifth of that here.

As for vegetables, the primary topic of this piece, shelter is the solution.

Outside, natural protection takes time, while a polytunnel -- or more popularly these days, the polycrub -- is effectively immediate. And within a translucent nissan hut, almost anything is possible: strawberries, tomatoes, courgettes, french beans, and, with luck, peppers are, among those popular fruits and veg that need heat. With good ventilation, produce that appreciates cooler environs are successful: carrots,



peas, asparagus, cabbage, kale, carrots, etc.

The tricky manoeuvre, however is pleasing both heat-lovers and more natural Highland crops. Although the shelter defeats the winds, it is less accommodating with temperatures which can vary from 5 to 35 degrees Celsius. Brassicas (cabbages, calabrese, cauliflower) and root veg (turnips, beetroot, et al) tend to bolt in such extremes, while a tomato plant will likely sulk. One option is to plant out those plants that dislike

heat early and late in the traditional growing season. Choose early or late maturing varieties. As for warmth-lovers, don't be too hasty to get them in the soil every spring. Let the soil heat up first, and wait for the coolest nights to pass.

Watering is often a concern in polytunnels and their ilk, though you might not be surprised that the amount of groundwater in our Lews environs assists greatly. Drip systems are best for growing under cover; they distribute the agua where it is needed -- near the roots. Alternatively, I have found a good long soak works well: vary it as weather dictates. In the occasional hot, dry spell plants will need more. In more common overcast periods, less.

Finally, resist chemical treatments. Go natural. Introduce wild-flowers. Allow some veg to go to flower and seed. Create a pool (add some irises and celandine pinched from a nearby ditch). Make your own compost and enrich the soil. Don't be too tidy all the time. Keep the door ajar. You'll find a balance will occur with a range of hover flies, spiders, bumble bees, butterflies, moths, and toads, which will in turn feast on aphids, slugs, and other predators on your precious crops.

* **Robert Louis Stevenson, A Biography.**
Claire Harman.

Barry Shelby
Earshader



'I do like to be beside the seaside'

I moved to Bernera a year ago after falling in love with the beautiful beaches and the outdoor lifestyle the island offers. I grew up in a seaside town so have always been drawn to the coast and over



Natalie Bowling
Valasay

the years have got into surfing and paddle boarding.

The feel of sand on my feet and the sound of the ocean never fails to make me smile (even in the Hebridean winter with the gales and sideways rain).

Feeling grateful to be back in the sea now the lockdown restrictions have been relaxed a little.



FROM 'LOO TO LEWIS

As a Sydney-sider I used to visit patients in Woolloomooloo when working as a community nurse, so I was fascinated to read about Murdo Morrison travelling to Woolloomooloo (Sydney) in 1870 to work there to finance the setting up of the Loch Risay Lobster Pond. I thought it would be interesting to find out what the 'Loo was like in the 1870s when Murdo worked there. 'Woolloomooloo is the name given to the horseshoe-shaped valley immediately east of the original settlement of Sydney'. Described as a 'very pretty' place of villas and gardens in 1845, by the late 1870s the area was in decline. It became dilapidated and unsanitary with 'houses in the area next to the bay that had seen better days.' The social decline of Woolloomooloo

was linked to the expansion of wharfage in the area. Once the mangrove swamps around Yurong Creek were drained in the 1850s, and a new semi-circular wharf was constructed in 1866, maritime activity increased. Over the following decades the area became crowded with small houses, pubs, brothels and billiard rooms servicing a maritime-focussed population. The wharf was used by small coastal timber traders and the adjoining land became dotted with sawmills and timber yards as well as small-time boatbuilding. It was also the centre of Sydney's fishing trade which sold fish washed in the filthy water of the bay near a major sewer outlet. The fish were sold directly from the wharf until 1872 when a new fish market was built nearby. I wonder if Murdo

thought longingly of his Bernera fishing days as he worked in the far-flung colony, perhaps in the fishing trade or maybe in the timber yards. Fortunately, he did return and with enough money for his ingenious venture.



Photo: Colin Halliday

Virginia Allum
Earshader



BERNERA BAKES... RED SOUP

INGREDIENTS

- 1** chopped onion
- 1lb** chopped carrots
- 6oz** red lentils
- 2** cloves garlic
- 1tbsp** paprika
- 1tsp** caraway seeds
- 2pints** vegetable stock (2 cubes)
- 1tbsp** tomato puree
- salt
- pepper

METHOD

- Saute onions for 5 mins
- Add carrots, garlic, paprika & caraway seeds - saute further 2 mins
- Add hot vegetable stock, tomato puree, salt, pepper & lentils
- Bring to the boil & simmer until cooked

Garnish & serve with crusty rolls or bread



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

We hope you enjoyed the general knowledge quiz that Colin sent in for our last issue. Here are the answers:

- | | | |
|-------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Romanov | 11. Pluto | 21. California Redwood |
| 2. Vital Spark | 12. Fiona Bruce | 22. Nine |
| 3. Pink River Dolphins | 13. Spruce Goose | 23. American Express |
| 4. Charles Innes | 14. Bobby Moore | 24. Whiskers |
| 5. 1000 | 15. River Tay | 25. Knights Templar |
| 6. Ruthwell | 16. Bournville | 26. Model T Ford |
| 7. Thursday | 17. Amstrad | 27. Andorra |
| 8. Mary Rose | 18. Avengers | 28. Madagascar |
| 9. Macbeth | 19. St Andrews | 29. Great Wall of China |
| 10. Robert Baden Powell | 20. Lowestoft | 30. Egyptians |

BUSINESS BERNERA

As life slowly starts to change again, many businesses are starting to reopen with staff being brought back into work. Some of these businesses have had government support but too many have not been eligible for funding because the nature of their work is seasonal and their employees are casual or they just don't meet the narrow criteria. Here at the **Bernera News** we are going to try to help the Bernera and

Tir Mor community know what local businesses and services are available and what they are doing to reopen.

We will highlight these services over the coming months as we move to a monthly newsletter, in a series of listings and articles which tell their stories. If you'd like your business or service to be included, please email

Julia@thedailyceilidh.co.uk or call **01851 600 159** for more information on how to get involved. These listings are free for any business to make use of and can include any kind of service including Sole traders, freelancers, Ltd companies, CIC's, partnerships and more. We will also provide links to organisations that are based further afield but that deliver services in the Bernera and Tir Mor area.

AN IMPENETRABLE PROTECTION

During the Second World war a German air raid took place against the Island of Lewis. As the planes came near to the island, the pilots on board these German planes exercised all their practical and technical knowledge as they prepared themselves to attack. Fingers poised over their 'fire' button, the order was given to begin the attack. Immediately, they pressed hard expecting a loud, mechanical, multi-round series of mini shell explosions as the bullets exited the plane's guns. Instead, they were met with silence. Again, and again, they tried unsuccessfully to commence their attack but with the same result.

Reluctantly, they abandoned their mission and returned home to Germany, feeling dejected and defeated.

During their debrief they informed their Superiors – "There was something around that island. An invisible wall of protection". Physically, no such wall, barrier or protection existed but spiritually it did. A wall of prayer. A true story that encourages us also to pray believingly, that the **'fervent prayer of a righteous man avails much'**, James 5:16b, in God's Kingdom'.



And as we glance in the 'rear view mirror' of time since Lockdown began over 3 months ago we too observe with thanksgiving and praise that God has again erected an invisible and effective wall of protection around our island in response to the prayers of His own faithful people. Reminding, and encouraging us that God is as ready and willing to hear and respond to our prayers today as He has ever been. Why not give Him a call, through faith in Jesus yourself today?

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



CHURCH UPDATE

As Lockdown measures continue to be relaxed, preparations have begun for the safe and practical re-opening of the church, when permitted. Parishioners will be regularly be updated as to progress.

VIRTUAL SERVICES.

For those of you with access to the internet, Lochs-in-Bernera Church of Scotland offers regular virtual services as listed below.

Online Sunday Service - 10:30 am

(Available on the Church's Facebook page or Youtube Channel)

Online Sunday School - 12 noon

Online Prayer Meeting - 7 pm each Thursday evening.

Both the online Sunday School and the Prayer Meeting are hosted on video conferencing. They are open to all, please

email the Minister at **berneralwuig@btinternet.com** to receive a secure invitation.

PASTORAL CARE

The Minister is available 24/7 to offer pastoral care to anyone in the Parish of Bernera whether or not they come to church.

He may be contacted on:

(01851) 672 388 or **07971 057915** or by e-mail at **berneralwuig@btinternet.com**.